

TFG Copilot · prototype-v0

Wizard-of-Oz kit for the Smallest Test · Venture Skeleton v0 · Rapid Prototyping with AI, IE University

What this tests

Riskiest assumption (assumptions.md): students will use it instead of their AI of choice.

Hypothesis (experiment-card.md): final-year IE students, about to do a real TFG task with their own AI available, will do that task with the copilot instead of their own AI.

How it runs

10 final-year classmates, one at a time, about 25 minutes each. The student sees a chat called **TFG Copilot (IE pilot)** that appears to know their topic, the TFG guidelines for their degree and their notes. Behind it, a team member answers from the official guidelines. The student is told to use anything they want, including their own AI. We record whether they switch.

What we commit to before the test

Metric: students who complete the task in the copilot chat without opening their own AI, count out of 10.

Threshold: at least 6 of 10. Set now, not moved after the result.

Decision rule: met, CONTINUE by building a working slice of the chat with the IE guidelines loaded.

Missed, CHANGE by reframing the copilot as a complement used alongside their own AI, and rerun. No ambiguous branch, the metric is a count out of 10.

Evidence strength: MEDIUM. Real target users, real task, simulated tool, one session.

Contents

- Page 2 · What the student sees (this is the artifact; also saved as prototype-v0-backup.png)
- Page 3 · Task brief, handed to the student
- Page 4 · Wizard protocol, behind the curtain
- Page 5 · Observation sheet, one row per student
- Page 6 · Intentionally excluded, and what is still unsupported

What the student sees

The promise is the product: it already knows your topic, your guidelines and your draft. The look matters less than that promise.

TFG Copilot

IE pilot

[Student name] · BDBA · 2026-27

Topic: [assigned topic / line]

Guidelines: TFG 2026-27 (your degree) loaded

Your notes: notes.pdf

Hi [name]. I have your TFG topic, the TFG guidelines for your degree and the notes you sent. Ask me whether your idea fits your topic, which sections and format the TFG needs, the key dates, or paste a paragraph and I'll check it against the guidelines.

Pilot: replies can take up to a minute.

Does an ML model to predict churn for a fintech fit my topic 'Applied AI in Business'?

Yes, on two conditions from the guidelines (§2.1 Scope of the applied line): the model has to be tied to a business decision, not just accuracy, and you need a data source you can actually access. Which of those two is less clear for you right now?

Does my idea fit my topic?

Which sections must the TFG have?

When is the first deliverable due?

Ask about your TFG, or paste a paragraph to check...

Send

Pilot version. Some responses are prepared with human help. Nothing you share is stored after the session.

How to run it next week: any chat window the student types into while you answer from another device. A Teams chat named "TFG Copilot", a shared doc, or a one-file web chat all work. Keep the header, the context chips and the pilot note; they carry the promise.

Task brief

Print or paste this. Hand it to the student and start the clock.

TFG Copilot pilot · your 15 minutes

Thanks for helping. This is an early pilot of a TFG helper the university might offer. You'll do three real things for your own TFG. **Use whatever you normally use:** Google, your own AI, the TFG Copilot chat, anything. Nothing is graded and there are no right answers.

1. Check whether your project idea (or the idea you're considering) fits the topic or line you've been assigned. Write the answer and one reason.
2. Find out the structure your TFG must have (the required sections) and one format requirement.
3. Find the key dates for this year's TFG deliverables.

Write your three answers here:

Afterwards we'll ask you two short questions about how it went. Part of this pilot is operated manually; we'll explain at the end.

Why the brief is written this way

- "Use whatever you normally use" is not politeness, it is the test. Substitution is only observable if their own AI is on the table.
- The three tasks are the ones the copilot is loaded for (fit, structure, dates). Anything else is out of scope on purpose.
- "Part of this pilot is operated manually" is the consent line the course asks for in a Wizard of Oz. Full reveal comes after.

Wizard protocol

Behind the curtain. Same rules for every student, or the count is not comparable.

Before each session

- Two days before: ask the student for degree, assigned topic or line, whether they've started, and optional notes or draft.
- Load the official IE TFG guidelines for their degree (structure, format, dates), their topic and their notes. Verify the dates and sections in the actual document, not from memory.
- Prepare three answer templates (fit, structure, dates) with the guideline section names ready to cite.
- Open the chat window and the observation sheet. A second person observes if possible; otherwise screen share, with consent.

During

- Reply within 60 seconds. Draft with your own AI if you want, then check every claim against the guidelines before sending.
- Answer only from the guidelines and the student's material, and cite the section ("Guidelines §3.2 Structure").
- If it's not in the guidelines: "I don't have that in the TFG guidelines for your degree; that one is for your supervisor."
- Never invent a date. Never write thesis text for them. Never grade or approve; "this fits" is a check against the topic, not an approval.
- Tone: a good supervisor in a hurry. Short, specific, one clarifying question at most.
- Do not prompt them to use the chat. If they leave for their own AI, let them. That is the data.

After

- Reveal: "Some answers were prepared by a person using the guidelines. Thanks for testing."
- Ask: (1) What did you use for each of the three tasks, and why? (2) Would you use this next week for your real work, instead of, or alongside, your AI?
- Fill the observation sheet immediately, while you remember the minute they switched.
- Delete any thesis text shared, unless the student agrees to keep it.

Observation sheet

One row per student. A student counts as "completed without own AI" only if all three tasks were done in the chat and their own AI was never opened in the 15 minutes.

#	Degree	Started?	Tasks done in copilot (1 / 2 / 3)	Opened own AI? (y/n, minute)	Turns	Switched for...	Quote / note
1							
2							
3							
4							
5							
6							
7							
8							
9							
10							

Tally, filled after the tenth session

Completed all three tasks in the copilot without opening their own AI: ____ / **10**

Threshold: **6 or more** → CONTINUE, build a working slice with the IE guidelines loaded.

Fewer than 6 → CHANGE, reframe the copilot as a complement alongside their own AI, and rerun.

Fewer than 10 students tested → no decision yet; recruit and finish the sample.

Intentionally excluded

Not built, on purpose. The test is about substitution, not capability.

- **No automation behind the chat.** Answers are human, drafted with a general AI and checked against the guidelines.
- **No memory across sessions.** One session per student.
- **No thesis writing.** The copilot checks and explains; it never drafts TFG text.
- **No grading, approval or supervisor view.**
- **No login, no IE systems integration, no data kept after the session.**
- **Only three task types:** topic fit, structure and format, dates. Everything else gets "ask your supervisor".

Still unsupported after this test

- That drift is real and detected late (assumptions.md, Area 1, first assumption). Assumed from experience. The two post-session questions and the "Switched for..." column start gathering it for free.
- Everything in Area 3, IE backing. Not touched by this test.
- Whether substitution holds beyond one session. This is why evidence strength is MEDIUM, not HIGH.

Cheaper test we considered and rejected

Interviews alone. Cheaper, but they can only report what students say they would use, and the assumption map already flags that saying and doing differ here. A fake door was rejected because clicking "try it" does not show anyone doing their work in it.